

St. Margaret's Cemetery Annual Report TIRRA AGM May 24 2025

It was a quiet year in terms of burial at the cemetery.

There was only one cremation burial. There were two memorial headstones installed in the new Memorial Garden area.

Five cremation plots were sold as well as two Natural Burial plots.

Financial report attached.

Sid Mawson built a long wished for storage shed and installed the water tanks in a new location next to the shed.

It has been a very busy year for the cemetery in terms of furthering along our development of a natural burial area. The committee which had been formed to research and report to the Cemetery board on the viability of a natural Burial grounds presented their findings in July 2024. It was unanimous that the committee members had done an outstanding job. All three proposals had each their own distinctive flavour. All were possible roads forward. All asked questions and presented data that impacted the Board's decision as to how to proceed.

The board 's decision was as follows:

- TO proceed slowly and not rush into development on a large scale. This was further encouraged with a site visit from Mike Harris a geologist specializing in hydrology.
- Immediate removal of Blackberries in the 6-meter corridor along the property line with Capernwray.
- Creation of a series of proposed rain garden pools and connecting ditches within that 6-meter corridor on Capernwray property in partnership with Capernwray. Designed in collaboration with Scott Murdoch Landscape Architect.
- To proceed with the removal of stumps and the management of dead trees in the undeveloped area of the cemetery. Some to be left as nature trees, others to be removed. This will help us get a better lay of the land as we move slowly towards its development.
- Creation of 20 Natural Burial plots in the old cemetery and phasing out traditional coffin burials over the next five years.

The Rules and Regulations were revised to meet the new practises (Natural Burials and Memorial Garden) in the cemetery. The fee schedule adjusted accordingly.

A new brochure with information on the Natural Burial Practises in the cemetery is in its final stages of design and will be made available to anyone interested.

The AGM will be held on June 3 ,6:30 PM at the hall. We welcome anyone interested in working on the cemetery board.

We thank Norm Kasting for his continued lawn maintenance. And TIRRA for their continued support.

Suzanne Sarioglu
Chair, St. Margaret's Cemetery

ST. MARGARET'S CEMETERY

Thetis Island

REVENUE AND EXPENSES AS OF DECEMBER 2024

(With comparative figures for 2023)

REVENUES	2024	2023
Sales of grave and cremation spaces,	\$4,600.00	\$2,600.00
Donations		\$1,500.00
Plot preparation costs		\$225.00
Bank Interest,	\$1.00	\$3.00
Lives behind the headstones	\$40.00	\$126.00
	\$4,641.00	\$4,454.00
EXPENSES		
Survey work, ThInc	\$50.00	\$84.00
Grounds maintenance and sundry	\$175.00	\$180.00
Professional services	\$937.00	\$1,643.00
Bank Service charges	\$5.00	\$9.00
	\$1,167.00	\$1,916.00
Excess of revenues over expenses	\$3,474.00	\$2,538.00

St. Margaret's Cemetery is a registered charity for income tax purposes.

Simone Luckham, Treasurer St. Margaret's Cemetery Thetis Island, May 2025

ST. MARGARET'S CEMETERY**Thetis Island****BALANCE SHEET AS OF DECEMBER 31 2024**

(With comparative figures for 2022)

	2024	2023
ASSETS		
Cash in bank account *	\$37,167.00	\$18,536.00
CIBC Bonus Savings Account, including interest		\$15,157.00
Expenditures on addition to Cemetery land	\$3,409.00	\$3,409.00
	\$40,576.00	\$37,102.00
CAPITAL		
Amount at beginning of year	\$37,102.00	\$34,564.00
Excess of revenues over expenses for the year	\$3,474.00	\$2,538.00
	\$40,576.00	\$37,102.00

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*As previously noted, the St. Margaret's cemetery changed their banking to the Coastal Community Credit Union in Chemainus in June 2024

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